

Theme 4: Travel and Transport

The Train is Approaching! (Informative essay & conjunctions)

Lesson 4-5
Book pages 58-59

💡 **Big idea:** We read an **informative essay** about the **Oman Rail Project**: a 2,244 km network linking major cities, ports and the GCC, with **economic, social and environmental benefits**. We study essay structure and **conjunctions**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Analyse the structure of an informative essay
- Identify topic and supporting sentences
- Recognise types of conjunctions
- Plan and write an informative essay

📖 Key words

informative إخباري / معلوماتي	**network** شبكة	**freight** البضائع المنقولة	**benefit** فائدة
employment opportunities فرص عمل	**prosperous** مزدهر	**conjunction** أداة ربط	**coherent** مترابط

The Oman Rail Project

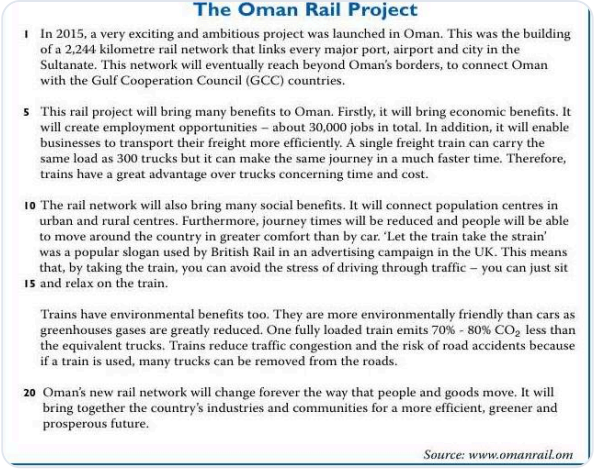
- Launched in 2015
- 2,244 km linking ports, airports and cities, and later the GCC
- Economic benefits: about 30,000 jobs
- one freight train can carry the same load as 300 trucks
- Social benefits: connects urban and rural areas
- travel is more comfortable
- Environmental benefits: 70-80% less CO2 than trucks
- less congestion and fewer accidents

Types of conjunctions

- addition: moreover, also, in addition, furthermore
- contrast: but, although, however
- reason: because, due to
- result: therefore, as a result
- example: for example, such as
- time: before, then, firstly, eventually
- similarity: in the same way, similarly

Informative essay structure

- Introduction: present the topic
- Body paragraphs: each with a topic sentence and supporting sentences
- Conclusion: summarise the main points



The Oman Rail Project

In 2015, a very exciting and ambitious project was launched in Oman. This was the building of a 2,244 kilometre rail network that links every major port, airport and city in the Sultanate. This network will eventually reach beyond Oman's borders, to connect Oman with the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries.

This rail project will bring many benefits to Oman. Firstly, it will bring economic benefits. It will create employment opportunities – about 30,000 jobs in total. In addition, it will enable businesses to transport their freight more efficiently. A single freight train can carry the same load as 300 trucks but it can make the same journey in a much faster time. Therefore, trains have a great advantage over trucks concerning time and cost.

The rail network will also bring many social benefits. It will connect population centres in urban and rural centres. Furthermore, journey times will be reduced and people will be able to move around the country in greater comfort than by car. 'Let the train take the strain' was a popular slogan used by British Rail in an advertising campaign in the UK. This means that, by taking the train, you can avoid the stress of driving through traffic – you can just sit and relax on the train.

Trains have environmental benefits too. They are more environmentally friendly than cars as greenhouses gases are greatly reduced. One fully loaded train emits 70% - 80% CO_2 less than the equivalent trucks. Trains reduce traffic congestion and the risk of road accidents because if a train is used, many trucks can be removed from the roads.

Oman's new rail network will change forever the way that people and goods move. It will bring together the country's industries and communities for a more efficient, greener and prosperous future.

Source: www.omanrail.om

The Oman Rail Project essay (p.58)

Types of Conjunctions	Examples
1 addition	a in the same way, similarly
2 contrast	b because, due to
3 reason	c moreover, also, in addition, furthermore
4 time	d for example, such as
5 result	e but, although, however
6 example	f therefore, as a result
7 similarity	g before, then, firstly, eventually

Types of conjunctions (p.59)

✏️ Examples

What type of conjunction is 'therefore'?

Answer: result

Join with a conjunction of contrast: Parents cannot change other drivers. They can make their own car safer.

Answer: Although parents cannot change other drivers, they can make their own car safer.

⭐ Remember

- Good use of conjunctions makes your essay read smoothly and clearly.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ However I like trains, I drive. ✓ Although I like trains, I drive.

🧩 **Activity:** Write an informative essay (150-200 words) about a transport project or a type of transport, using at least five conjunctions.

✅ Check yourself

1. Length of the Oman rail network?
2. One freight train equals how many trucks?
3. Type of 'moreover'?
4. Type of 'because'?

Answers: (1) 2,244 km ، (2) 300 ، (3) addition ، (4) reason